government as the youngest member of his cabinet against the advice of several older colleagues, with great contempt. Soon after they returned to Pakistan, he embarked on a series of vitriolic public attacks on Ayub's "betrayal" of Pakistan at Tashkent. It was the start of Bhutto's own campaign for the presidency. The rhetorical scorn he hurled at Ayub won wild acclaim from crowds of Punjabis and Sindis in Lahore and Karachi. The charismatic Bhutto ripped open the buttons of his silk shirts as he roused crowds of frustrated Punjabi students and unemployed Sindis to cheer him and curse Ayub, who soon fired Bhutto from the cabinet. Bhutto then started his Pakistan People's Party (PPP), whose popular mantra promised "Bread, Clothing, and Housing" ("Roti, Kapra aur Makan") to Pakistan's impoverished masses. Bhutto's passion and promises hypnotized audiences, mobilizing young women as well as men; his wife, Nusrat, and daughter, Benazir, joined him in challenging Pakistan's wealthiest "twenty-two families" and vast landowning old guard, promising peasants, workers, and women a richer, happier, brighter future.

Riots spread across East and West Pakistan, leading Ayub to reimpose martial law early in 1969, filling Dhaka's jails and Punjab's fortress prisons with lawyers and other political prisoners. Students kept shouting, "Ayub must go!" but the field marshal seemed deaf to such protests. Then, in February, Bhutto announced his intention "to fast until death," the only time he ever followed in Mahatma Gandhi's footsteps, and three days later Ayub lifted his draconian martial law, losing heart as he faced growing calls from old friends to step down. All of Sind seemed to celebrate with songs and street dancing, shouts of "*Jiye* Bhutto!" ("Long live Bhutto!") echoing from Karachi to the North-West Frontier. Bhutto was hailed as the *Quaid-i-Azam* (leader of the people), a title he retained for the rest of his life, till that of Shaheed (martyr) was added to it when he was hanged.

On Pakistan Day, 25 March 1969, Ayub surrendered his marshal's baton, handing it down to General Aga Mohammad Yahya Khan, a much smaller Pathan, and a heavier drinker. Yahya was a boon companion of Bhutto's, often visiting the latter's huge ancestral estate in Sind's Larkana, where they hunted wild boar together and drank all night. Pressure from Washington to hold a general election mounted as the cost of America's military aid to Pakistan grew much higher than anticipated. General strikes in East Pakistan and social disorder in West Pakistan spread with such alarming speed that the country seemed ready to collapse rather than growing stronger. Yahya, therefore, agreed to preside